Development	**Content**
Key Concepts	• Stages of development; pre-natal; childhood; adolescence; and adulthood • The development of brain structures and functions; the nervous system; neurons; synapses; and their interaction in development of the brain • IQ tests as a measure of intelligence.
Theories/Explanations Piaget's Theory of Cognitive Development The Role of Learning on Development – Dweck's Mindset Theory Willingham's Learning Theory	• Piaget's Theory of Cognitive Development: ◦ The four invariant stages of development: sensori-motor; pre-operational; concrete-operational; formal operational ◦ assimilation and accommodation ◦ the concepts of object permanence; animism; and egocentrism ◦ the processes of decentration; reversibility; and conservation ◦ criticisms of the theory including the reductionism/holism debate. Cognitive Development Research Study – Piaget (1952): Study into the conservation of number. • Learning theories of development: ◦ Dweck's ideas on fixed and growth mindsets ◦ Dweck's ideas on praise for effort ◦ Willingham's ideas on the myth of learning styles ◦ Willingham's ideas on the importance of meaning for learning ◦ criticisms of learning theories including the nature/nurture debate. Learning Research Study – Blackwell et al. (2007): study into fixed and growth mindsets.
Application The changing role of education	• How Piaget's ideas have been applied to education through the use of key stages, readiness, active learning and the concept of intelligence • How learning theories apply to the development of education and intelligence through growth mindsets and teaching through meaning not learning styles.